a community responsibility and should be delivered and funded as a community/state enterprise. On the other hand, as a private good, technical education should be delivered and funded as a private enterprise.

In India, all educational institutions can be established only as a ‘society’, ‘trust’ or ‘not-for-profit’ company. Educational institutions, including technical education institutions, cannot be established legally as proprietary or partnership companies or any other ‘for-profit’ entity. This policy is incorporated in all the education-related laws of the Centre and states. The mindset of all educationists is informed by the requirements of general education and it makes no distinction between general and technical education. The courts, including the Supreme Court, have upheld this. NEP-2020 also carries forward the same idea.

India needs to abandon the policy of keeping technical education institutions as not-for-profit institutions. All fit-for-purpose private entrepreneurs and companies should be free to establish technical institutions without the requirement of a licence or approval and charge any fees. When buying and selling of goods and most services require no licence and they can be bought and sold with the mutual consent and agreement of the buyer and seller for the consideration, why should learning and imparting skills not be so? A regulator of technical education in the states and one central technical education regulator for technical institutions in more than one state can at best lay down standards in terms of physical and digital facilities, teachers, and other relevant matters. Just like credit-rating agencies in the assets field, technical education rating agencies should be established to rate these institutions. Let students decide on institutions they consider appropriate and pay for their education through appropriate finance.

The policy proposed for technical institutions should also be made applicable to HEIs, or higher educational institutions. All graduate and postgraduate colleges should be governed by the same policy. Only school